

Uddhav P. Gautam

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July 11, 2026

Search Committee, Director of Information Technology
College of Agriculture and Life Sciences & Division of Information Technology
Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, Virginia

Re: Director of Information Technology, College of Agriculture and Life Sciences (Requisition 536827)

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Director of Information Technology position with the College of Agriculture and Life Sciences (Requisition 536827). I bring a decade of industry experience in software and IT, most recently as an architect and technical lead. I hold a Master's in Computer Science and am completing a PhD in Computer Engineering at Virginia Tech, where I work as a researcher and mentor students. I understand both the technology this role governs and the teaching, research, and Extension mission it supports.

As an architect and technical lead at Perficient, I led an eight-engineer Android team, with software engineers reporting to me, and set the engineering standards and architecture for a regulated platform that carried 30M+ users through the TD Ameritrade–Charles Schwab migration. Earlier, I spent four years as a system and network administrator, responsible for the infrastructure and daily operations of the organizations I supported. I have built CI/CD and DevSecOps pipelines and used production telemetry to drive measurable results, including a 40% reduction in crash rate.

This position reports to both CALS and the Division of Information Technology and delivers services through a matrixed model. My work has had that structure throughout. In consulting I answered to both the client and my own firm; as a technical lead I set priorities and allocated resources across competing stakeholders; and as the founder of my own company I make budget and investment decisions directly. Because I run my own research at Virginia Tech, I also know what faculty need from research computing and data infrastructure, and I have taught here as a graduate teaching assistant.

I am a U.S. citizen and an honorably discharged veteran of the U.S. Army Reserve, where I held a Secret security clearance and can obtain one again. I require no visa sponsorship. I would welcome the chance to discuss how I can help CALS align its technology with the college's teaching, research, and Extension goals. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Uddhav P. Gautam